

Maxims Interiors — staff CMS guide

A practical reference for the Maxims team

This is the working guide for staff using the Maxims administration area. It is deliberately written around the real administrative modules in this application: dashboard, products, gallery, orders, appointments, messages, testimonials, newsletter, team, settings, and activity.

Before you begin

- Use your own staff invitation and password. Do not share an admin account.
- Work from a current Chrome, Edge, or Safari browser and keep the site URL bookmarked.
- Use clear, original product photographs. Prepare the product name, price, available quantity, dimensions, materials, delivery lead time, and a short customer-friendly description before starting.
- If a page displays an error, take a screenshot, note the page address and time, and report it to the site administrator rather than repeatedly submitting the form.

Daily opening routine

1. Sign in to the administration area.
2. Start on **Dashboard** and check new orders, bulk requests, appointments, unread messages, and low-stock items.
3. Open **Activity** when you need to see what was changed, by whom, and when.
4. Assign customer follow-up to a named staff member; do not leave a sales enquiry without an owner.

Adding a product

1. Go to **Products** and choose **Add product**.
2. Enter a specific product name customers can search for. Avoid internal abbreviations.
3. Select the correct collection or category, then write a short summary and a full description.
4. Add price, currency, available stock, dimensions, materials, finishes, and delivery information.
5. Upload the cleanest front-facing image first; it becomes the default card image. Add detail, scale, and lifestyle images after it.
6. Review the customer preview. Confirm that the title, price, stock label, gallery order, and call-to-action are correct.
7. Save as draft if the item is not ready. Publish only when stock, images, and commercial details are confirmed.

Updating stock, price, or availability

1. Open **Products**, search for the product, and select **Edit**.
2. Update stock immediately after a sale, supplier confirmation, return, or damage adjustment.
3. If no units are available, set the item to out of stock or hide it; do not leave a purchasable item with zero stock.
4. Update a price only after approval. Check the customer-facing product page after saving.
5. Add a note in the internal activity record when a significant price or availability change is made.

Managing orders and custom requests

- **Orders:** confirm payment status, verify delivery address and contact details, update the fulfilment stage, and record dispatch/tracking information.
- **Bulk requests:** acknowledge the request quickly, confirm quantity and specification, then send the approved quotation through the team's approved communication channel.
- **Appointments:** confirm date, time, location or virtual meeting link, responsible consultant, and any customer preparation needed.
- **Messages:** reply with a clear next step. If a message needs a quote, mark the owner and follow-up time so it is not lost.

Gallery and testimonials

- Use **Gallery** for finished spaces and editorial images. Add useful titles, room/category labels, and concise captions.
- Do not publish customer homes, names, addresses, or photographs without the client's permission.
- Add testimonials only after permission is documented. Correct obvious spelling only; do not change the customer's meaning.

Newsletter and customer communication

1. Build content in **Newsletter** using approved brand language and imagery.
2. Check audience, sender name, subject line, links, mobile layout, and unsubscribe text before scheduling.
3. Send a test to an internal address first.
4. For billing, order, password, and account notifications, use the approved transactional sender and template; never send those from a marketing newsletter sender.

Team and permissions

- Invite each staff member through **Settings** or **Team** using their work email.

- Give the lowest permission level that lets them do their job.
- Remove access immediately when a staff member leaves or changes role.
- Admin access is for settings, staff access, commercial configuration, and high-impact publishing—not everyday product entry.

Image quality checklist

- Crop intentionally: product centred, no accidental empty space, and no stretched images.
- Use the same aspect ratio for product-card images where possible.
- Check the desktop and phone previews before publishing.
- Use descriptive image names and alt text when the CMS provides a field.

Escalation rules

- Do not alter payment, email-domain, DNS, API, or security settings unless you are the designated administrator.
- Escalate duplicate charges, suspected account compromise, data-loss risks, abusive messages, or a site outage immediately.
- Include screenshots, order/customer reference (never card details), page URL, time, and the steps that caused the issue.

End-of-day routine

1. Ensure every new order, appointment, bulk request, and message has an owner and next action.
2. Confirm stock changes are recorded.
3. Review today's activity for accidental changes.
4. Sign out on shared devices.